

Business Without You

Cool Hollow Coaching — Tier 1 Program Curriculum

12 weeks. 7 milestones. 15 hours back, and up to \$50,000 in profit found.

Curriculum version: Learn, See, Do, Extend (revised June 30, 2026 — Senteo consultant feedback)

Milestone Order

Reordered from the original sequence so the dashboard goes in before the profit and cash work, and constraint-breaking comes after there is real financial data to point it at.

#	Milestone	Lead(s)
1	Reclaim the Owner's Time and Identity	Mark
2	Define the Destination with Precision	Mark
3	Install the Dashboard That Tells the Truth	Mark + Cam (CFO)
4	Discover the Hidden Profit	Cam (CFO)
5	Build Cash Confidence	Cam (CFO)
6	Break the Binding Constraint	Mark
7	Build the Team That Builds the Business	Hannah (hiring specialist)

12-Week Delivery Schedule

8 teaching weeks, 3 implementation weeks, 1 finale. Discover the Hidden Profit and Build Cash Confidence are kept adjacent so Cam teaches two weeks back to back.

Week	Content	Leads
1	Reclaim the Owner's Time and Identity	Mark
2	Define the Destination with Precision	Mark
3	Implementation week	—
4	Install the Dashboard That Tells the Truth	Mark + Cam (CFO)
5	Discover the Hidden Profit	Cam (CFO)
6	Build Cash Confidence	Cam (CFO)
7	Implementation week	—
8	Break the Binding Constraint	Mark
9	Implementation week	—
10	Build the Team, Part 1	Hannah (hiring specialist)
11	Build the Team, Part 2	Hannah (hiring specialist)
12	The Liberation Finale	Mark

The Consistent 4-Step Flow

Every milestone follows the same structure. This replaced the prior Exercise / Model / Videos / Diagnosis order based on feedback from the Senteo consultant call. The original structure had no practice rep before owners touched their own data, which caused freezing and errors. The Do step is the fix.

Step	What it is	Format	Length
Learn	Mark (or specialist) teaches the theory or methodology	Video	8 to 12 min
See	A case study or real example showing the method in action.	Video	8 to 12 min
Do	Guided worksheet on a fictional sample business — Works on owner's own. Practice rep with no risk.	Worksheet	15 to 20 min
Extend	Owner applies the method to their own business using the milestone tool.	Table + reflection tool.	20 to 30 min

Important: do not film any videos before running Milestones 1, 2, and 3 live on Zoom with 3 to 4 beta clients. Refine from that feedback, then film.

Every video is 8 to 15 minutes maximum. If a lesson runs past 15 minutes it gets split into two videos.

Milestone 1: Reclaim the Owner's Time and Identity

Lead: Mark | Week: 1 | Tool: Already built and live — [apps/reclaim-protocol/](#)

Learn

Theory: the owner is the bottleneck because they handle everything once it hits them. Introduce the OHIO method: Only Handle It Once. Every task that lands on your desk gets one of three answers: do it now, delegate it, or cancel it. There is no fourth option.

Story prompt for Mark: Mike Ruckman's boss Jim Rice preached OHIO to his whole team, then had an office full of floor-to-ceiling piles when Mike visited. Most owners are like that. They coach their teams better than they coach themselves. Tell a version of this. It lands.

Also introduce Jobs to Be Done: owners keep doing jobs that belong to someone else not because they are control freaks, but because no one else has been set up to do them. The Liberation Audit surfaces which jobs those are.

See

Case study: a composite blue-collar owner (HVAC, roofing, or electrical) who tracked their week and found they were the only person who could quote jobs, approve timesheets, order materials, and handle customer complaints. Four jobs, zero delegation. Walk through exactly what they did in week one of the program and what changed in 30 days.

Do

Students get a pre-filled sample time log for a fictional owner, Dan's Plumbing. Dan worked 64 hours last week. The worksheet asks: which of Dan's tasks fall into do / delegate / cancel? Which jobs are his by habit, not by necessity? Students rank them and produce a rough Reclaim list for Dan before they ever open the tool on their own data.

Extend

Liberation Audit + Reclaim Protocol tool. Students run the Liberation Audit on their own week. Upload their time log. The model scores it, ranks delegate / automate / eliminate candidates by hours and readiness, and outputs their personal 15-Hour Reclaim Protocol with deadlines.

Milestone 2: Define the Destination with Precision

Lead: Mark | Week: 2 | Tool: Already built and live — [apps/impact-map/](#)

Learn

Theory: most owner-operators have a to-do list, not a strategy. The Strategy Razor is one filter: for every initiative you are chasing, ask whether it moves the business toward the one destination you have named. If it does not, it gets cut or parked. Introduce the Core Customer Decree (exactly who you are building this for) and the Unfair Advantage (what you can do that others cannot).

See

Case study: a roofing company owner who had 14 priorities for the year. Walk through applying the Strategy Razor live: what survived, what got cut, and why the three things that survived were the ones that actually moved the needle. Show the before and after.

Do

Students get a pre-written list of 12 initiatives from a fictional business, Greenfield Electrical. Their job is to apply the Strategy Razor: which ones survive the filter? They write a one-line Core Customer Decree for Greenfield and identify one Unfair Advantage from the description given.

Extend

Strategy Razor + Impact Map tool. Students submit their own initiative list. The model applies the Razor, outputs their 12-Month Impact Map (3 to 5 priorities), and gives a focus score showing what percentage of planned work got cut and why.

Milestone 3: Install the Dashboard That Tells the Truth

Lead: Mark + Cam (CFO) | Week: 4 | Tool: Already built and live — [apps/dashboard-selector/](#)

Learn

Theory: most owners track too many numbers or none. Five is the right number. Introduce the five metric categories: cash, sales, delivery, customer, and team. One metric per category, reviewed in 15 minutes every Monday. Introduce red / yellow / green thresholds as a decision trigger, not just a reporting tool.

See

Case study: a glazing company owner who was looking at a spreadsheet with 40 rows every week and making no decisions from it because it was too much to read. Walk through how they went to five numbers, what those five numbers were, and what changed in how they ran the business.

Do

Students are given a list of 18 potential metrics from a fictional HVAC company. Their job is to pick five, one per category, and set a rough red / yellow / green threshold for each. No tool yet. Just the judgment call.

Extend

Five Metric Dashboard Selector tool. Students submit their own current metrics and raw data. The model selects their five, sets thresholds calibrated to their targets, and flags up to two leading indicators.

Milestone 4: Discover the Hidden Profit

Lead: Cam (CFO) | Week: 5 | Tool: Already built and live — [apps/profit-discovery-audit/](#)

Learn

Theory: hidden profit exists in three places in almost every business this size: underpriced jobs, underperforming customers, and cost leakage they have never looked at. Introduce the Profit Discovery Audit framework. Cam explains why most owners never find it: they look at net profit as a single number rather than breaking it apart by job type, customer, and expense category.

See

Case study: a real or composite example where the CFO ran a P&L; breakdown for a trades owner and found that two service lines were running at negative margin while a third was carrying the business. The owner had no idea. Walk through the numbers and what the owner changed.

Do

Students are given a simplified, pre-filled P&L; for Harbor Fleet Maintenance. Their job is to identify three potential profit leaks using the Audit framework before any tool does it for them. They write their guesses down and explain their reasoning.

Extend

Profit Discovery Audit tool. Students upload their own P&L; and customer / service breakdown. The model scores pricing gaps, cost inefficiencies, customer profitability, service mix, and revenue leakage and outputs a dollar figure with specific levers.

Milestone 5: Build Cash Confidence

Lead: Cam (CFO) | Week: 6 | Tool: Already built and live — [apps/cash-confidence/](#)

Learn

Theory: cash and profit are not the same thing. A business can be profitable and run out of cash. Introduce the 13-week rolling forecast as the owner's visibility window: it does not need to be perfect, it needs to be honest. Introduce the two levers: receivables timing (the most commonly overlooked) and expense timing.

See

Case study: a commercial refrigeration owner who had a profitable month on paper and then could not make payroll because three large accounts were 60 days overdue. Walk through how the 13-week forecast would have shown the problem six weeks earlier and what the owner now does differently.

Do

Students are given a simplified AR aging report and expense list for a fictional business. Their job is to manually build a rough four-week cash picture and identify which receivables are most at risk before the tool does it for them.

Extend

13-Week Cash Forecast + Decision Filter tool. Students input their own AR / AP data, recurring expenses, and payment timing. The model outputs their 13-week rolling forecast, the Financial Decision Filter, and flags overdue receivables by customer with exact amounts sitting beyond their stated payment terms.

Milestone 6: Break the Binding Constraint

Lead: Mark | Week: 8 | Tool: Already built and live — [apps/bottleneck-breakthrough/](#)

Learn

Theory: every business has one constraint that limits everything else. It is almost never the one the owner thinks it is. Introduce the constraint identification method: map three core processes, look for the step where work piles up or gets delayed, that is the constraint. Fixing anything else first is waste.

See

Case study: an electrical contractor who thought his problem was not enough sales. The constraint was actually the estimating process: one person (him) had to approve every quote. Sales were not the problem. Throughput was. Walk through what changed when he solved the real constraint instead of the assumed one.

Do

Students are given a process map for Bramblewood Creative with five steps, capacity numbers at each step, and a job queue snapshot. Their job is to identify the binding constraint and write one sentence explaining why it is the bottleneck and not one of the others.

Extend

Bottleneck Breakthrough Plan tool. Students map their own three core processes and submit the Constraint Identification worksheet. The model ranks constraints by impact and frequency, names the single binding constraint, and outputs the Bottleneck Breakthrough Plan.

Milestone 7: Build the Team That Builds the Business

Lead: Hannah (hiring specialist) | Week: 10 to 11 (two-week milestone) | Tool: Already built and live — [apps/team-builder/](#)

Learn

Theory: most small business owners hire for availability, not outcomes. Introduce outcome-based hiring: every role gets defined by what it must produce, not what it must do. Introduce the Delegation Transfer Protocol: the owner is not the ceiling, the team is.

See

Case study: a trades business owner who had hired the same person three times in a row (fired each one) because the job description said manage operations with no measurable outcome attached. Walk through how rewriting the role around outcomes changed who applied, and how the third hire after the rewrite lasted and delivered.

Do

Students are given two job descriptions for the same role: one written in task language, one written in outcome language. Their job is to (1) identify the difference, (2) rewrite a third job description given to them in task language into outcome language, and (3) write two interview questions that test for the outcome, not the task.

Extend

Team Builder tool. Students submit their role inventory, current job descriptions, and delegation map. The model outputs outcome-based hiring templates per role, a delegation-level gap score, and a leadership trait scorecard for ranking candidates.

Week 12: The Liberation Finale

Lead: Mark | Not a teaching week. A structured reflection and handoff.

Each owner presents their single biggest result from the 12 weeks — one number, one story.

Mark does a group Diagnosis: what is each owner's biggest remaining constraint going into the next 90 days?

Community status is introduced here: graduates who want to stay and mentor the next cohort get a reduced rate and a named role. This is the first ask for ongoing community membership.

Notes for Mark Before Any Filming Happens

1. Do not film a single video yet. Run Milestones 1, 2, and 3 live on Zoom with 3 to 4 beta clients first. Treat them as working sessions, not polished presentations. Get feedback on every step.
2. Every video should be 8 to 12 minutes. If a lesson runs past 15 minutes, it gets split into two videos.
3. The OHIO method story and the Jobs to Be Done framing go into Milestone 1's Learn video. Mike Ruckman offered to help develop some of this content. Take him up on it.
4. Mark's commitment is roughly 1.5 to 2 hours a week on calls. Videos are filmed once, after the live rounds are refined.
5. Cam delivers Milestones 4 and 5 as the CFO voice and co-leads Milestone 3. Hannah delivers Milestone 7.
7. Mark opens and closes every milestone and owns all live Q&A.;